A TIMELESS LEGACY

The launch of The Amrut Expedition—the oldest single malt ever made in India—has ushered a golden moment for the country's spirits. Here's why Indian whisky is pro age.

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In 2010, when the youngest whisky in Amrut Expedition was being placed in casks at a warehouse somewhere near Bengaluru, few could have predicted that it would develop into a fine 15-year-old single malt. At that time, Indian whiskies were just starting to gain recognition and respect was still a tall ask. Over the past 15 years, things have changed. Even though age has always been a discerning factor in whisky, today, there is a competing appreciation for grain whiskies and non-aged varieties too. Although age still conveys distinction and often correlates with higher quality and premium pricing, this does not necessarily imply that all aged whiskies are superior or that non-aged whiskies lack merit; rather, age introduces additional dimensions. The new Amrut Expedition showcases layers of aroma and complexity while competing effectively with global whiskies, prompting a revaluation of ageing within Indian whiskies.

The Amrut Expedition launch is a first of its kind in India's alco-bev industry, with Amrut releasing the country's oldest single malt ever made with an unprecedented 15-year maturation period; something never seen before in Indian whisky-making. It initially matured for eight years in a specially procured Sherry cask from Europe, developing rich, indulgent flavours, before it was moved into an ex-Bourbon cask from America for a further seven years, further developing its complexity and depth. With a limited edition of just 75 bottles, this is more than a whisky; it is a landmark moment in India's whisky history.